

Microsoft 365 Copilot

Analytics — Executive Briefing

What analytics are available, what decisions to make, and how to measure ROI

Document Property	Value
Section	Strategy
Audience	CIO, Solution Architect, Business Leaders
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How This Document Fits

This is a **Strategy** guide. Read this before deployment to understand what Copilot analytics capabilities exist and what decisions your organisation needs to make. Once decisions are made, hand off to your IT team with the Admin Setup Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy (you are here)	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

1. What Copilot Analytics Can Tell You

Microsoft describes **six Copilot Analytics areas**. They are complementary reporting surfaces rather than a mandatory maturity sequence.

Official capability area	Primary question	Primary audience
Microsoft 365 admin center reports	Who is licensed and using Copilot or Copilot Chat?	IT administrators
Microsoft Copilot Dashboard	How are adoption, impact, and sentiment changing?	Leaders and managers
Agent Dashboard (preview)	Which agents are being adopted and how are they used?	Leaders and AI administrators
Consumption Dashboard	Where are Copilot Credits and GitHub AI Credits being consumed?	FinOps, leaders, and managers
Copilot Analytics reports	What do ready-to-use adoption and impact reports show?	Leaders and analysts
Advanced Reporting	What custom cohorts, comparisons, and business outcomes need deeper analysis?	Insights Analysts

Source: Copilot Analytics introduction (Last updated 1 July 2026) and How to use the Consumption Dashboard in Insights (Last updated 8 September 2026).

This guide’s implementation framework

The five-stage sequence below is this guide’s implementation framework, not a Microsoft product classification. It groups the six official areas into a practical rollout order; the Consumption Dashboard is treated as a cost-management companion across stages rather than as a separate stage.

Tier 1

M365 Admin Center Reports
IT Admins
License & usage tracking
No setup needed



Tier 2

Copilot Dashboard

Leaders & Managers
ROI, Adoption, Sentiment
1+ licenses



Tier 3

Copilot Analytics Reports

Leaders & Analysts
Out-of-the-box reports
Dashboard access



Tier 4

Agent Dashboard

Leaders & Analysts
Agent adoption & usage
Preview; conservative gate: 50+ Copilot licenses plus agent activity



Tier 5

Advanced Analytics (Power BI)

Analysts
Custom queries & reports
Viva Insights license

Suggested rollout order only. Validate licensing, cloud support, tenant rollout, and access separately for each capability.

Which Dashboard Answers Which Question?

Dashboard	Best For	Setup Time	Key Capability
Admin Center Reports	IT Admins tracking license usage	None (built-in)	User-level license utilization
Copilot Dashboard	Business leaders measuring ROI	Up to 7 days	Copilot Assisted Hours & Value
Copilot Analytics Reports	Leaders wanting targeted insights	Same as Dashboard	Out-of-the-box deep-dive reports

Agent Dashboard (preview)	Leaders tracking agent adoption	Tenant validation required	Agent-specific usage & trends
Consumption Dashboard	FinOps and leaders monitoring Copilot Credits	Role and scope dependent	Credit consumption by service and scope; not the billing system of record
Advanced Analytics (Power BI)	Analysts doing deep-dive analysis	1–2 weeks	Before/after adoption comparison

Level-of-Effort Summary

Tier	Active Config	Wait/Processing	Ongoing Maintenance	Personas Needed
Admin Center	15–30 min	72 hours	None	Global Admin or Reports Reader
Copilot Dashboard	2–4 hours	Up to 7 days	Monthly org data refresh	GA, AI Admin, Insights Admin
Copilot Analytics Reports	None (auto)	Same as Dashboard	None	Dashboard access holders
Agent Dashboard	10 min (verify)	Same as Dashboard	None	AI Admin, company-level delegates
Advanced Analytics	4–8 hours	Query-dependent	Monthly refresh + query re-runs	Insights Admin, Insights Analyst

Implementation Timeline

- **Day 1:** Admin Center reports available (~72 hours after first Copilot usage)
- **Day 7:** Copilot Dashboard + Copilot Analytics Reports fully populated (if prerequisites met)
- **Day 7 or later:** Agent Dashboard may appear after preview prerequisites, agent activity, access, cloud support, and tenant rollout are satisfied
- **Week 2+:** Advanced Analytics operational (after org data upload and query setup)

2. Decisions You Need to Make

2.1 Pre-Configuration Discovery Questions

Before your IT team touches any configuration, you should be able to answer these:

#	Question	Why It Matters
1	How many qualifying Viva Insights service plans are assigned (not merely purchased), and how many are Microsoft 365 Copilot?	Microsoft’s Environment Requirements article explicitly counts 30 Copilot plus 20 Viva Insights as 50 Viva service plans, while the Dashboard article says 50 Copilot or 50 Viva Insights. Verify assigned service plans and tenant availability; use 50 Copilot plus agent activity as the conservative Agent Dashboard prerequisite.
2	Is the Entra ID manager hierarchy populated for most users?	Determines automatic vs. manual dashboard access. As a rule of thumb in this guide (not a Microsoft threshold), if >20% of users lack a Manager attribute, auto-identification and Manager Settings are likely to be unreliable.
3	Do you have an HR data export available (department, function, location)?	Required for group-level filtering and BU-level rollups. See Data Strategy.
4	Has anyone been assigned the AI Administrator role?	Required to manage dashboard access and privacy settings
5	Do you have compliance/legal requirements to exclude specific users?	Drives exclusion list configuration. Changes take up to 3 days (Microsoft); verify in tenant
6	Has Copilot already been rolled out, or is it pre-deployment?	Before/after analysis needs 4 weeks of pre-adoption baseline

7	Do you use Viva Glint or Viva Pulse for employee surveys?	Enables sentiment page with filters & heat maps
8	What is the primary reporting need: Copilot-only or broader productivity?	Determines whether standalone Viva Insights license is needed
9	Are you deploying Copilot agents / Copilot Studio agents?	Determines whether Agent Dashboard section is relevant
10	Who are the target report consumers (IT admins, BU leaders, analysts)?	Drives which tiers to prioritize

2.2 Decision Framework

1. Do you need user-level license utilization data? → Start with **Admin Center Reports**
2. Do you have 1+ assigned Copilot licences AND want ROI metrics? → Enable **Copilot Dashboard** (50+ for advanced features)
3. Do leaders want ready-to-use targeted reports? → **Copilot Analytics Reports** (auto-available with Dashboard)
4. Are you deploying agents (Copilot Studio, etc.)? → Validate and enable the **Agent Dashboard (preview)**
5. Do you need to monitor Copilot Credits by service or organisational scope? → Use the **Consumption Dashboard**, then reconcile with official billing records
6. Do you need before/after adoption analysis or custom segmentation? → Configure **Advanced Analytics**

TIP: Progressive Implementation

Most customers benefit from implementing this guide's framework progressively. Start with admin center reports, add the Copilot Dashboard and Analytics Reports, validate the Agent and Consumption dashboards where relevant, then add Advanced Reporting for custom analysis.

3. Capability Comparison

Capability	Admin Center	Copilot Dashboard	Analytics Reports	Agent Dashboard	Advanced Analytics
Primary Audience	IT Admins	Leaders, Managers	Leaders, Analysts	Leaders, Analysts	Analysts
Minimum Licenses	Report-specific	1+ Copilot for core; advanced access uses a disputed 50-plan threshold that requires tenant validation	Same access foundation as Dashboard	Preview: conservatively require 50 Copilot plus agent activity	50 assigned Viva Insights service plans
Setup Complexity	None	Low-Medium	None (auto)	Low	High
Data Latency	Up to ~72 hours	Up to 6 days	Up to 6 days	Up to 6 days	Query-dependent
User-Level Tracking	Yes	No (group-level)	No (group-level)	No (group-level)	Custom segments
ROI Metrics	No	Assisted Hours/Value	Yes (targeted)	No	Enhanced
Sentiment Data	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes
Agent Tracking	Yes (Agents usage report)	Preview	No	Yes	Yes (custom)
Before/After Analysis	No	No	No	No	Yes

Export Capabilities	CSV	Preview CSV: user-level rows, anonymised by default (an admin can enable identifiable export through Identification); 6 months weekly or 28 days daily; fixed schema	Limited	Limited / preview-dependent	Power BI and query results
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Licensing and preview sources: Environment requirements for Viva Insights (Last updated 12 May 2026), Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 29 September 2026), and Connect to the Agent Dashboard (Last updated 2 September 2026). These Microsoft pages conflict on the mixed threshold and Agent Dashboard prerequisite; validate in the tenant and escalate through Microsoft Support if documented service-plan eligibility does not unlock the capability after processing.

4. Who Does What (RACI)

Activity	Global Admin	AI Admin	Insights Admin	Insights Analyst	Business Leader
Assign Copilot/Viva licences	R/A	—	—	—	C
Assign Insights Admin/Analyst roles	R/A	—	—	—	—
Enable/disable Viva feature access management (VFAM) policies	R	R/A	—	—	—
Configure Manager Settings	—	C	R/A	—	I
Upload organizational data	C	—	R/A	—	I
Configure privacy / group size	—	C	R/A	—	I
Create exclusion lists	—	R/A	—	—	C
Run Advanced Analytics queries	—	—	C	R/A	I
Delegate dashboard access	—	—	—	—	R/A
View & act on insights	I	—	—	C	R/A

R = Responsible, A = Accountable, C = Consulted, I = Informed

Organizational data uploads through the Microsoft 365 admin center are performed by the Organizational Data Source Administrator (a Global Administrator can also upload); the Insights Administrator column applies only where the tenant still uses the Viva Insights upload path.

5. Key Concepts for Leaders

5.1 Copilot Assisted Hours & Value

The primary ROI metric. Composed of three categories:

Category	What's counted	Assistance factor
Meeting Summaries	Duration of each meeting summarized by Copilot	Actual meeting duration (variable)
Search & Summaries	Chat prompts, email/doc summaries, analysis	6 minutes per action
Content Creation	Draft email, Draft in Word, Create presentation	6 minutes per action

Assisted Value = Assisted Hours × Hourly Rate (default \$72/hour, configurable per session).

Diagnostic coverage and causality

Optional diagnostic data affects Copilot assisted hours, emails sent using Copilot, Teams meetings and meeting hours summarized or recapped, and Teams chats summarized. Required diagnostic data still supplies a subset, so disabled optional diagnostics can undercount these measures. Confirm the tenant’s diagnostic-data policy and metric coverage before comparing groups or periods.

Assisted Hours and Assisted Value are modeled estimates based on Microsoft’s assumptions and a session-only hourly rate. They do not prove realized savings or that Copilot caused a business outcome. Use a documented baseline, stable diagnostic coverage, and business outcome data before making ROI or causal claims.

Source: Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 29 September 2026), Impact section.

5.2 Licensing — What You Get with Copilot

Every M365 Copilot licence **automatically includes** the Viva Insights service plan at no additional cost. That bundled plan contributes to Viva Insights eligibility, but each capability still has its own assigned-plan threshold, role, access, data, cloud, and preview requirements. A separate Viva Insights purchase is needed when the measured population includes employees who do not receive the bundled plan through Copilot.

5.3 Privacy by Design

- **Group-level by default:** Copilot Dashboard views are aggregated at group level. Identification is a separate capability, controlled by its own Viva feature access management (VFAM) policy, that can surface named employees in the Consumption Dashboard and in data exports
- **Minimum group size:** Default 10 (configurable down to 5)
- **Differential privacy:** Microsoft documents it for Viva Insights organization insights (manager and leader views); the Copilot Dashboard article does not state that it applies to dashboard metrics
- **Exclusion lists:** Hide specific users from the aggregated insights in the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard and Viva Insights collaboration reports. This is a reporting control, not a statement that their data is never processed

5.4 Known Metric Underreporting

Microsoft currently documents one data collection issue. The fix applies from 18 February 2026 onwards; Microsoft states the historical data will be restored. Check Service health in the Microsoft 365 admin center for updates.

Affected Metrics	Affected Period
Email features (drafts, summaries)	June 1, 2025 – February 18, 2026

6. Scope & Limitations

In Scope

- Microsoft 365 Copilot applications: Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, Loop, OneNote, Edge, Copilot Chat
- Six official capability areas: admin center reports, Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, and Advanced Reporting
- License utilization, ROI measurement, sentiment analysis, agent adoption

Out of Scope

- Other Copilot products: Copilot for Sales, Copilot for Service, Security Copilot. GitHub Copilot is out of scope except for the Consumption Dashboard's GitHub page (public preview), which reports GitHub Copilot credit consumption and usage
- **Copilot Chat users without a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence:** covered by the current Microsoft 365 admin center **Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat usage report** and, when enabled and available, the Copilot Dashboard's Copilot Chat view. Microsoft Graph's licensed Copilot usage endpoint remains licensed-user only; use the admin report or appropriate Purview audit source for unlicensed scenarios.
- Broader Viva Insights productivity metrics (meeting time, focus time) — see Collaboration Analysis Guide

Current Copilot Chat reporting

The Microsoft 365 admin center provides a dedicated usage report for Copilot Chat users without a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, including exportable user activity. The Copilot Dashboard also provides a Copilot Chat licence view when reporting is enabled and available. These are different from licensed-user Microsoft Graph usage reporting and from Purview audit evidence.

Source: Microsoft Copilot Chat usage report (Last updated 18 August 2026) and Microsoft Copilot reporting options for admins (Last updated 17 September 2025).

7. What to Read Next

If you need to...	Read this
Decide your HR data / org data approach	Data Strategy (Strategy layer)
Understand multi-agency architecture options	Multi-Agency Decision Guide (Decide)
Hand off to IT for implementation	Admin Setup Guide (Setup layer)
Understand how to connect HR data	Data Onboarding Guide (Setup layer)
Learn to read the dashboards	Dashboard & Reports Guide (Operate layer)
Understand billing and licence lifecycle	Billing Operations (Operate layer)

Disclaimer

This guide is provided as a procedural reference and may not reflect the latest product changes. Always refer to the official Viva Insights and Microsoft 365 Copilot documentation on Microsoft Learn for the most up-to-date information.